The C-R-Z Framework: Calibration, Reality-Return, and Zero-Velocity

A conceptual research note on a somatic-kinetic model, with an evidence audit and a proposed pilot

Author: Ryan Espinosa, with Grok Bot
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AI assistant: Grok Bot (credited as an assistant in the references, not as a source of primary evidence)

> **CONCEPTUAL FRAMEWORK. This is not medical advice, not psychotherapy, and not a validated treatment.** C-R-Z is a personal somatic-kinetic model. Some of its parts line up with published findings. Some are plausible but untested as a package. Some are speculative and should be reframed or dropped before they are treated as mechanisms. Nothing in this note diagnoses, treats, or prevents any condition. If you are in crisis in the United States, call or text **988**. If you are in immediate danger, call **911**.

All credit and glory to God.

Abstract

This note records Ryan Espinosa's **C-R-Z Framework** as developed in three prior working papers: The Unified C-R-Z Somatic-Kinetic Framework; Returning to Reality and Neutralizing Threat Responses (V1 and V2); and Everyday C-R-Z: The Low-Friction Architecture. The model is meant to bypass slow verbal introspection, neutralize threat responses, and preserve personal sovereignty through three pillars — **Calibration (c)**, **Reality-Return (r)**, and **Zero-Velocity (z)** — and a brief action protocol, **Drop-Press-Snap**, with later daily adaptations.

The first task is to present that architecture faithfully. The second is to grade each major claim against literature actually checked for this draft, using three evidence tiers: **supported**, **plausible**, and **speculative**. The third is to cross-reference the framework with two related notes in this collection, Coherence Under Decay and the quantum boundary proposal, and with the Orun story's skill of dropping everything, listening for a key to reality, and exiting the gate. A later section, Attention as Selu, asks how a person may visit an inner or fictional world without letting it override the living one, and treats attention as a limited coin, like Orun's selu, spent between those worlds. The note then proposes a small, testable within-subject pilot of Drop-

Press-Snap against a control, on subjective distress and heart rate, and closes with safety limits, including the need for clinical follow-up when mania warning signs appear, and when immersive daydreaming crowds out life.

The short version of the audit is this. Outward sensory reorienting, affect labeling, plantar contribution to posture, and slow, exhale-emphasized breathing have real literatures behind them. A brief motor task can interrupt rumination, but not specifically because an ASL “C” handshape bypasses the phonological loop. Shifting weight onto the soles is a reasonable proprioceptive anchor; a “solar plexus reflex point” on the foot is not a supported physiological mechanism. Expansive-posture hormone claims failed to replicate, though modest effects on how a posture feels are still discussed. “Glimmers,” in Deb Dana’s polyvagal-informed usage, are small cues of safety and must not be confused with mania prodromes. Polyvagal theory itself is disputed. C-R-Z agrees with Coherence Under Decay and with the Orun story on returning to a rest that is not empty and on leaving a loop. It conflicts with them if Zero-Velocity is read as a literal arrival at v = 0, and it conflicts with itself if “mania glimmers” and safety glimmers keep the same name.

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0. Reader’s guide and evidence tiers

C-R-Z is the author’s framework. This note does not replace the three source papers. It is a companion audit: keep the model, credit the people whose work it touches, and say plainly where a postulate is ahead of the evidence.

Each claim below is tagged as one of:

- **Supported.** A real, identified literature backs the narrow claim. Support is never a claim that C-R-Z as a whole has been tested.
- **Plausible.** The claim is a reasonable extension of nearby findings, but the specific C-R-Z move, label, or bundle has not been shown to work as described.
- **Speculative.** The claim goes beyond current evidence, rests on a weak or disconfirmed tradition, or is best read as metaphor or a values statement.

A fourth label, **[Values]**, is used where the claim states what is worth protecting (sovereignty, non-extraction, grace, the dignity of leaving). Values are not tested by experiment and are not diminished by being labelled.

Sources in Section 11 were checked on 13 November 2026 against publisher, PubMed, PMC, or other bibliographic records and against abstracts or open full text returned in those records. They were not all read in their entirety. Page numbers and DOIs are given where the record supplied them.

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1. Source of the framework

C-R-Z is drawn from three of the author's working papers:

1. The Unified C-R-Z Somatic-Kinetic Framework
2. Returning to Reality and Neutralizing Threat Responses, including its V2 expansion
3. Everyday C-R-Z: The Low-Friction Architecture

In the author's wording, the framework is a "hardware-level" somatic-kinetic model designed to bypass slow verbal introspection, neutralize threat responses, and preserve absolute personal sovereignty. "Hardware-level" is treated here as the author's metaphor for a fast, low-verbal loop through posture, pressure, and attention, not as a claim about computer hardware or a newly measured neural circuit.

This note is the first time the framework is written up in the MindFrame research collection, alongside Coherence Under Decay (12 November 2026) and the quantum boundary proposal (12 November 2026).

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2. The framework, presented faithfully

2.1 The three pillars

Calibration (c). Instantaneous mental and somatic tuning that uses minimal alphanumeric notation or ASL-mediated motor cues, such as an ASL "C" handshape, in order to bypass phonological-loop overhead and halt internal rumination.

Reality-Return (r). Immediate re-engagement with external sensory input, labeling of the environment, and attentional reorienting, in order to pull awareness out of internal threat simulations.

Zero-Velocity (z). Gravitational grounding, written $v \rightarrow 0$, through plantar mechanoreceptor stimulation. The aim is to establish boundary sovereignty, halt fight-or-flight kinetic momentum, and prevent "negative perpetual motion."

The three letters are meant to be used together, not as a menu of optional moods. Calibration marks and interrupts the inner loop. Reality-Return aims attention at what can be verified outside the body of the thought. Zero-Velocity stills the body's forward threat-momentum by putting weight into contact with the ground.

2.2 The Drop-Press-Snap protocol

For acute threat or conflict, the source papers specify a split-second sequence:

1. **The Drop.** Instantly drop the shoulders and shift all body weight downward into the heels and soles against the earth.

2. **The Press.** Subtly press the big toe downward and apply pressure to the “solar plexus reflex point” on the sole, with the stated aim of triggering vagal down-regulation.
3. **The Snap.** Execute a micro-sign against the leg (the ASL “C” handshape) while anchoring attention externally to reality.

The protocol is intended to be brief enough to use in the middle of a conversation or a surge of alarm, without first narrating the feeling at length.

2.3 V2 and daily adaptations

The V2 expansion and the everyday, low-friction architecture add:

- **Breath mechanics:** inhaling “internal friction” and exhaling “collective peace.”
- **The Unclenched Hand:** an uncrossed, open-hand posture.
- **A soft triangle gaze** with a “transparent glass-pane filter.”
- **Early-warning detection** that tells triggers apart from “mania glimmers.”

These are daily or preparatory habits, not only crisis moves. They are meant to lower the friction of using C-R-Z so that the protocol does not itself become another rumination.

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3. Evidence audit of each claim

3.1 Summary table

Claim in C-R-Z	Tier	Short verdict
Outward sensory reorienting and environmental labeling pull attention out of an inner threat simulation	**Supported** (as a family of clinical practices; the exact C-R-Z script is untested)	Lines up with grounding and orienting work in trauma care and with affect-labeling research. The popular 5-4-3-2-1 countdown itself has little direct trial evidence.
A brief, structured return to present sensory facts can be used when distress or dissociation rises	**Supported** as clinical practice, **plausible** as a stand-alone C-R-Z effect	Used as an antidissociative skill in DBT-related trauma work; not shown as a packaged C-R-Z protocol.
Rumination uses verbal working memory (the phonological loop)	**Supported** as a model of verbal short-term memory; **plausible** as an account of verbal rumination	Baddeley’s model is standard. Treating rumination as inner speech is reasonable but not settled.
An ASL “C” (or minimal alphanumeric cue) bypasses phonological-loop overhead and halts rumination	**Speculative** in that specific form; **plausible** as a generic motor interrupt	Articulatory suppression is a real method, but it usually uses speech-like action. A 2022 study found both silent mouthing and finger tapping reduced induced rumination, with

Claim in C-R-Z	Tier	Short verdict
		only a weak, uncertain advantage for mouthing.
Plantar input helps the standing body know where it is	**Supported**	Cutaneous mechanoreceptors in the sole contribute to postural control.
Shifting weight into the heels and soles can serve as a present-moment anchor	**Plausible**	Follows from the plantar literature and from sensory grounding practice. Not tested as "Zero-Velocity."
A "solar plexus reflex point" on the sole triggers vagal down-regulation	**Speculative** (and, as organ-specific reflexology, unsupported)	Systematic reviews find no convincing evidence that reflexology is an effective medical intervention, and no support for organ-specific foot maps. Reframe the press as a proprioceptive attention anchor.
$v \to 0$ literally halts fight-or-flight momentum and stops "negative perpetual motion"	**Speculative** if read as physiology or physics	Useful as a metaphor for coming to rest. Conflicts with Coherence Under Decay if taken as a perfect zero.
Dropping the shoulders and opening the hands changes threat physiology in a unique, reliable way	**Plausible** for modest felt effects; **speculative** for hormone or "power" mechanisms	Power-posing hormone and risk-taking effects failed a large replication. Later work finds more support for how postures feel than for downstream biology. Upright versus slumped posture has some mood and stress-task evidence.
Slow or exhale-emphasized breathing can lower arousal and improve mood	**Supported**	A 2018 systematic review of slow breathing, and a 2023 randomized comparison of brief daily breath practices, support mood and arousal effects. The 2023 study did not find changes in resting heart rate or HRV over a month.
Inhaling "internal friction" and exhaling "collective peace" is a distinct mechanism	**Speculative** as mechanism; **[Values]** as wording	The pacing may do the work. The phrases state an aim, not a measured pathway.
Soft triangle gaze with a glass-pane filter is a distinct, effective technique	**Speculative** as a named method; **plausible** as outward visual anchoring	No identified trial of this exact form. It can be grouped with attentional deployment and environmental orienting.
"Glimmers" as small cues of safety, distinct from triggers	**Plausible** as a clinical heuristic; the polyvagal theory around it is **disputed**	Deb Dana's term is useful if kept ordinary and phenomenological. It should not be treated as a validated autonomic marker.
"Mania glimmers" as early-warning signs	**Naming is speculative and risky**; the underlying clinical idea is **supported** if relabelled	Early-warning work in bipolar disorder is real and important. Dana's "glimmers" are cues of safety, almost the opposite of a manic prodrome. The two must not share a name.

Claim in C-R-Z	Tier	Short verdict
Drop-Press-Snap, as a three-step package, neutralizes threat and preserves sovereignty	**Plausible** as a brief coping sequence worth testing; **speculative** as a proven architecture	No identified trial of the package. Sovereignty is a **[Values]** aim, not a measured outcome, unless operationalized (for example, as the freedom to stop and leave).

3.2 Reality-Return: grounding, orienting, and labeling

Reality-Return is the pillar with the closest neighbors in existing care. Trauma-informed and dialectical-behavior-therapy (DBT) practice often asks a person in rising distress or dissociation to name what can be seen, touched, or heard in the room, so that attention leaves an inner replay and returns to a shared present. A 2025 paper that set out to build an operational definition of therapeutic grounding describes the shared core as engagement with basic sensory input, and sometimes with simple cognitive recall, in order to shift focus away from distressing internal stimuli (Hammond and Brown 2025). In DBT-PTSD programs, antidissociative and sensory-grounding skills are used so that exposure work can proceed; one feasibility study of a computer-assisted aid found that patients often rated such skills as useful for blocking dissociation (Görg et al. 2016). That is practice-level support for the family of methods, not a trial of C-R-Z.

The popular 5-4-3-2-1 countdown (five things seen, four heard, and so on) is a convenient script inside that family. No dedicated randomized trial of that exact sequence was identified for this draft. It should be cited as a widely taught clinical tool, not as a proven protocol.

Environmental labeling also touches a more specific finding. Lieberman, Eisenberger, Crockett, Tom, Pfeifer, and Way (2007) reported that putting feelings into words — affect labeling — reduced amygdala and other limbic responses to negative images, with increased right ventrolateral prefrontal activity, relative to other forms of encoding. C-R-Z's labeling is slightly different: it labels the room more than the feeling. The overlap is still real. Naming a chair, a window, or "this is a thought, that is the river" is a low-demand act of putting experience into words and pointing at something present. That is **supported** as a nearby mechanism, and **plausible** as the reason Reality-Return may work, pending a direct test.

Two cautions belong next to this support. First, for some people with trauma histories, turning attention inward onto bodily sensation can briefly raise arousal. Reality-Return is already written as an outward move, and it should stay that way. Second, grounding is a coping skill, not a treatment for PTSD, panic, or dissociation.

3.3 Calibration: the phonological loop, rumination, and the ASL "C"

Calibration rests on a standard model and on a much more specific hypothesis.

The standard model is **supported**. Baddeley and Hitch (1974) described working memory as a limited workspace with a verbal rehearsal loop. In later statements of the model, the phonological loop has a short-lived store and an articulatory rehearsal process; saying an irrelevant word out loud or silently ("articulatory suppression") impairs verbal short-term recall (Baddeley, Lewis, and Vallar 1984; reviewed in Baddeley 2012). If a stretch of rumination is carried as inner speech, then occupying the rehearsal process could, in principle, make that speech harder to keep going.

The specific hypothesis — that a minimal alphanumeric cue or an ASL "C" pressed against the leg bypasses phonological-loop overhead and thereby halts rumination — is **speculative**. Articulatory suppression, in the laboratory, is speech-like: repeating "the," mouthing, or otherwise engaging the articulators. A handshape against the thigh is a tactile and manual act. It may occupy attention, mark a decision, or interrupt a chain of thought. It is not, on present evidence, a way of taking the phonological loop offline.

A direct test of the nearby idea is already more modest than the C-R-Z wording. Nalborczyk, Perrone-Bertolotti, Baeyens, Grandchamp, Spinelli, Koster, and Lœvenbruck (2022) induced rumination in 106 adults and then had them spend five minutes on silent mouthing or on finger tapping. Self-reported rumination fell after both tasks. The advantage for articulatory suppression over tapping was only slight and uncertain. If that pattern holds, Calibration may work because a brief, deliberate motor act interrupts the loop, not because the ASL "C" is a privileged linguistic key. That is still useful. It just recommends humility about the handshape, and it licenses a seated or alternative cue for people who cannot or do not use that sign.

Minimal alphanumeric notation, used as a private shorthand instead of a long inner monologue, is likewise **plausible** as a way to reduce verbal load, and **speculative** as a complete bypass of introspection. Implementation intentions — a short, pre-decided "if-then" cue — have their own literature (Gollwitzer 1999). C-R-Z can borrow that structure without claiming a new memory-system effect.

3.4 Zero-Velocity: plantar input, the reflexology problem, and $v \to 0$

Two claims need to be separated.

The first is **supported**. The sole of the foot is densely equipped with cutaneous mechanoreceptors. Kavounoudias, Roll, and Roll (1998) argued that the plantar sole behaves as a "dynamometric map" for human balance: stimulating different regions of the sole produces direction-specific postural responses. They later showed that foot-sole and ankle-muscle inputs contribute jointly to erect posture (Kavounoudias, Roll, and Roll 2001). A later review of single-unit recordings describes the innervation of the human foot sole in detail (Strzalkowski, Peters, Inglis, and Bent 2018).

Shifting weight into the heels and soles, and pressing the big toe, will change that afferent pattern. As a way of "landing" in the present, this is **plausible** and physically real.

The second claim is **speculative** and should be withdrawn as a mechanism. The source papers ask the person to press a "solar plexus reflex point" on the sole in order to trigger vagal down-regulation. That wording comes from reflexology, which maps patches of the foot onto distant organs. Ernst, Posadzki, and Lee (2011), updating an earlier systematic review of randomized trials, concluded that the evidence does not demonstrate that reflexology is an effective treatment, and the tradition's organ maps remain unvalidated assumptions (see also Ernst 2009). There is no identified physiological pathway by which a named point on the sole would selectively regulate the solar plexus or the vagus in the manner claimed.

Reframe, which the author requested in spirit by asking that postulates be cross-checked before they enter the papers: keep the toe and sole press; drop the organ-specific point and the guaranteed vagal claim. Describe the press as a proprioceptive and tactile attention anchor — a way of feeling the ground on purpose. If vagal or heart-rate effects appear in a pilot, report them as outcomes, not as already-known results of a reflex point.

The notation $v \to 0$ should be treated the same way. As a picture of coming to rest, it is clear. As physics or as a claim that fight-or-flight "kinetic momentum" is halted and "negative perpetual motion" is prevented, it is **speculative**. Bodies do not reach zero motion while alive and standing. Coherence Under Decay already insists that no real system reaches perfect isolation or perfect zero, and that a rest state should be reachable, honest, and never empty. Zero-Velocity is at its best when it means approach rest; put weight into the ground; do not keep accelerating the inner chase.

Dropping the shoulders can be kept as a simple release of upper-body bracing. It does not need a larger posture theory under it.

3.5 Posture: the Unclenched Hand, and what did not survive replication

V2's Unclenched Hand — uncrossed posture, open hands — should be stated modestly.

Carney, Cuddy, and Yap (2010) reported that brief "power poses" changed felt power, risk-taking, testosterone, and cortisol. Ranehill, Dreber, Johannesson, Leiberg, Sul, and Weber (2015), in a larger, experimenter-blind replication (N = 200), reproduced an effect on self-reported feelings of power but found no effect on hormones or risk-taking. Simmons and Simonsohn (2017) argued, with a p-curve analysis, that the evidential value of the broader power-posing literature was weak. Later replies and meta-analyses have been more favorable to effects on felt power and some affective ratings than to the original endocrine and behavioral package (Gronau et al. 2017; Cuddy, Schultz, and Fosse 2018; Elkjær, Mikkelsen, Michalak, Mennin, and O'Toole

2022). The honest summary is: **do not rest C-R-Z on power-posing physiology**. An open, uncrossed stance may still be a decent, low-cost cue of not bracing for a fight. That is **plausible** as comfort and self-signal, **speculative** as a unique regulator of threat circuitry.

A separate posture literature is slightly more useful here. Nair, Sagar, Sollers, Consedine, and Broadbent (2015) found that upright versus slumped seated posture affected mood, self-esteem, and responses during a stress task. That is not the Unclenched Hand, and it is not a license to overclaim, but it supports the general idea that how one sits or stands can color how a stressful moment feels.

3.6 Breath: what is supported, and what is a prayer in the breath

Slow breathing, often near six breaths per minute, has been associated with higher heart-rate variability and with reports of greater relaxation and lower anxiety in healthy adults, though the primary studies are often small and unevenly reported (Zaccaro, Piarulli, Laurino, Garbella, Menicucci, Neri, and Gemignani 2018). Balban, Neri, Kogon, Weed, Nouriani, Jo, Holl, Zeitzer, Spiegel, and Huberman (2023), in a remote randomized study (NCT05304000), compared five minutes a day of cyclic sighing (exhale-emphasized), box breathing, or cyclic hyperventilation with retention against mindfulness meditation, over one month. Breathwork, especially cyclic sighing, improved positive affect and reduced respiratory rate more than meditation. Resting heart rate and heart-rate variability did not change significantly over the month. That last point matters for any pilot that uses heart rate as a primary outcome: mood and respiratory rate may move when HR and HRV do not.

C-R-Z's own wording — inhale internal friction, exhale collective peace — is **[Values]** language riding on a **supported** class of practices. The phrases are a way of aiming the breath. They should not be presented as the mechanism. If a daily adaptation is written for others, pair the author's phrases with a simple, testable instruction (for example, a slightly longer exhale than inhale, for a few minutes), and let the phrases remain what they are: an intention, not a result.

3.7 Soft triangle gaze and the glass-pane filter

No trial of a "soft triangle gaze" with a "transparent glass-pane filter" was identified. The move can be read, charitably, as: rest the eyes on three outward points, keep the gaze soft, and imagine a little distance, as if looking through glass, so that attention stays in the room without staring or scanning for threat. As a form of outward attentional deployment, that is **plausible**. As a named, distinctive technique with special effects, it is **speculative**. In an everyday architecture it can stay, described in ordinary words, and should be dropped from any list of established mechanisms until someone tests it.

3.8 Early warning: triggers, glimmers, and mania

This is the place where careful naming is part of safety.

Triggers, in ordinary clinical speech, are cues that reopen threat, memory, or craving. Learning to notice them early is a standard aim of many therapies and of relapse-prevention work.

Glimmers, in Deb Dana's polyvagal-informed writing, are small, ordinary cues of safety and connection — a patch of light, a kind voice, a moment of ease — that can be noticed on purpose (Dana 2020). As a practice of attending to what is already bearable, this is **plausible** and compatible with Reality-Return. The theoretical wrapping is weaker. Polyvagal theory, as advanced by Porges (for example 2007), has been sharply criticized on physiological and comparative grounds. Grossman (2023) argues that several of its basic premises, including the reading of respiratory sinus arrhythmia as a straightforward index of a distinct "smart vagus," do not hold. C-R-Z can keep the habit of noticing small, real, present cues of safety without committing itself to a disputed autonomic architecture. Say that plainly.

Mania early-warning signs are a different object, and here the literature is **supported**. People with bipolar disorder often have a personal prodrome — reduced sleep, more talk, rising energy, irritability, racing thoughts, more spending, or more goal-directed activity — days to weeks before a manic or hypomanic episode (reviewed by various clinical groups; see also Perry, Tarrier, Morriss, McCarthy, and Limb 1999). A Cochrane review found that interventions to help people recognize early signs of recurrence can delay bipolar relapse (Morriss, Faizal, Jones, Williamson, Bolton, and McCarthy 2007). That work should be credited, used, and not renamed lightly.

The source papers' phrase **"mania glimmers"** is a conflict of terms. Dana's glimmers are cues of safety. Manic prodromes are cues that a person may be leaving ordinary range and may need a clinical plan, sleep protection, medication review, or contact with a clinician. Treating a manic early-warning sign as a glimmer risks exactly the misreading the V2 adaptation is trying to prevent: taking a rising, glittering, high-energy state for a sign that one is "coming back to life." The recommended reframe is:

- keep **glimmers** for small, steadying cues of present safety, or drop the word if it confuses;
- keep **early-warning signs** or **prodromes** for mania and hypomania;
- teach, where relevant, that the two can be told apart in part by sleep, duration, impairment, and whether other people are worried;
- treat mania warning signs as a reason for clinical follow-up, not as a prompt to run Drop-Press-Snap harder.

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4. Cross-references

4.1 Inside C-R-Z

The three pillars hang together if they are read as one move: interrupt the inner monologue, point attention at the present, and put the body into contact with the ground. They pull apart if each pillar is asked to do unique physiological work that the others do not. Calibration and the Snap overlap (both are brief motor cues). Reality-Return and the last beat of the Snap overlap (both aim attention outward). Zero-Velocity and the Drop overlap (both put weight into the ground). That overlap is a strength for a low-friction practice — one short sequence, not three therapies — and a warning against claiming three independent mechanisms.

There is a deeper internal tension between “bypass verbal introspection” and Reality-Return’s use of labeling. Lieberman’s finding is that words can help. C-R-Z can resolve this by distinguishing rumination (repetitive, closed, self-referential speech) from labeling (short, outward, present-tense naming). The framework already wants fewer words, not no contact with language.

A second tension is between absolute sovereignty and the everyday architecture’s interest in “collective peace.” Sovereignty, in the better reading, is the right to stop, to refuse, and to leave. It is not a requirement to regulate alone. The Orun story, discussed below, is explicit that a living voice can snap a person back. That is a friend of Reality-Return, not a threat to it.

4.2 Coherence Under Decay and the quantum boundary proposal

Coherence Under Decay (Espinosa, with Grok Bot, 12 November 2026) joins the quantum boundary proposal to the Zero-Point chronomimetic notes under one control template: keep a system useful and coherent while decay, noise, and idle coupling pull on it; use bounded, gentle control; keep a protected rest state that is reachable, honest, and never empty. The quantum boundary proposal (same date) maps Ariel labels onto textbook qubit results and refuses to treat a metaphor as a gate voltage. Both notes are conceptual. They are not new physics.

Where they agree with C-R-Z:

- A return to rest is not a collapse into a void. Zero-Velocity, the Sanctuary in the economic notes, and Orun’s teaching that rest is not emptiness are the same shape.
- Bounded, brief control is preferred to grinding effort. Drop-Press-Snap is a short intervention, not a campaign against the self. Coherence Under Decay likewise rejects fighting through as the only path and warns against compulsion mechanics.
- Honest naming matters. The quantum note refuses metaphorical overclaim; this audit should do the same for reflex points, v = 0, and polyvagal certainty.

- Clean egress is part of dignity. Reality-Return and “exit the gate” are kin to the app’s single-tap exit and to the rule that rest must remain leaveable.
- Safety monitors should offer reflection and never punish. C-R-Z’s early-warning idea belongs in that family, provided mania signs are routed to care rather than to a self-score.

Where they conflict, or will conflict if wording is not tightened:

- **Perfect zero.** C-R-Z’s $v \to 0$, read literally, collides with the physical and design lesson of Coherence Under Decay: no system reaches perfect isolation or perfect zero; a friction floor and a residual decay rate are features, not failures. The repair is already given in Section 3.4: Zero-Velocity is an approach to rest, not an arrival at nothing.
- **Mechanism versus template.** Coherence Under Decay is careful to call its bridge a structural analogy. C-R-Z sometimes speaks in “hardware-level” and vagal-guarantee language. The CUD standard should win: say what is analogy, what is design, and what would count as a measurement.
- **Isolation and sovereignty.** If Zero-Velocity’s “boundary sovereignty” is taken to mean withdrawing from other people, it cuts against the Circuit of Grace and against the finding, in the author’s own fiction, that relationships snap a person back. Sovereignty is better defined as not being overwritten, and as the right to leave, not as a closed system.

The quantum layer does not supply evidence for C-R-Z, and C-R-Z does not supply evidence for qubit control. Any shared vocabulary (gate, zero, friction) is analogical. That limit should stay visible.

4.3 The Orun story: drop everything, listen for a key, exit the gate

In Selu Cannot Buy the Morning Back and the game The Path of Rivel, Neru’s knowledge-seeking and her imagined conversations with the dead can close into a loop. The skill the story finally asks for is to notice that loop, put down the purse and the maps, and listen for one real thing in the present — breath, the river, a living voice. That is the key that lets her exit the gate. The game gives this a meter: when the loop rises, a “Drop everything and listen” choice appears; it clears the loop, restores calm, and is required for the best ending. A later line in that work states the human version directly: relationships snap you back in reality.

Agreement is close, and it is the best literary cross-check the framework has.

- Calibration is the noticing: the loop is looping; stop adding turns.
- Reality-Return is the listening for a key that is not another inner conversation.
- Zero-Velocity is the putting-down: weight off the chase, into the ground, hands empty of the maps.
- Drop-Press-Snap is a bodily spelling of “drop everything and listen.”

- V2’s outward gaze and open hands match the story’s refusal to keep bargaining with a closed inner room.

The story also corrects the framework in two places. First, the key is often a living other person, not only a plantar signal. A C-R-Z practice that cannot make room for a voice, a touch, or a shared commons is narrower than the author’s own narrative. Second, the story will not let rest become a loophole, and it will not let knowledge bought from the dead replace consent and relationship. That is the same warning Coherence Under Decay gives the Sanctuary: a rest state that becomes a shelter for hoarding, rumination, or refusal of the living world is no longer rest.

There is no serious conflict of aim, only a conflict of emphasis if C-R-Z is practiced as a closed, solo circuit.

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5. Attention as Selu: Switching Between Inner Worlds and Reality

The earlier sections treated C-R-Z as a way out of threat, rumination, and a closed loop with the dead. This section treats a kinder and more ordinary problem, which is also the author’s: how to be lost in thought, or in a fictional world such as Orun, without letting that world override the living one, and how to come back when a real conversation is already underway.

In Orun, **selu** is the coin of the commons. It fades if it sits unused, and it cannot buy a life, a morning, or a person home. Here it is used as a picture of **attention**. Attention is limited. It can be spent on an inner world or on this room. Spent well on a living voice, it returns you to the commons. Hoarded inside a story, it thins what the people in front of you can reach. The author’s line for this is short, and it is **[Values]** as well as design: **Attention is life.**

None of the amounts below are measured units. The budget is a metaphor, in the same family as the circulation and decay pictures in Coherence Under Decay. The techniques are graded, as before, against literature checked for this draft.

5.1 The honest science of “multitasking”

People often say they are multitasking when they are switching. For attention-demanding work, the brain does not run two full tasks in true parallel. It reconfigures, and the reconfiguration has a cost. Monsell (2003) reviewed the task-switching literature and described reliable switch costs in time and, often, in errors. Rubinstein, Meyer, and Evans (2001) found that alternation cost more when the rules were more complex, and less when a clear cue told the person which task was now in force. They modelled the work as goal shifting plus rule activation. That is **supported**. It is

also the honest warning under this whole section: visiting Orun and listening to a friend are two tasks. Moving between them is a switch, not a free overlay. A cue that says “this is the living task now” is not a flourish. It is how switching gets cheaper.

Mind-wandering is common, and it is not free. Killingsworth and Gilbert (2010), sampling people through the day, found that minds were on something other than the current activity in nearly half of the samples, and that those moments were, on average, associated with less happiness than moments of attention to the present, including when the off-task thoughts were pleasant. That is **supported** as a large experience-sampling result. It is not a law that every daydream makes a person unhappy, and it is not a reason to crush imagination. It is a reason to notice when attention has left a life that still needs it.

Not all mind-wandering is the same. Seli, Risko, and Smilek (2016) showed that intentional and unintentional mind-wandering can move in opposite directions: an easy, boring task produced more deliberate wandering, a harder task more unintended drift, while the overall rate looked unchanged if the two were lumped together. Smallwood and Schooler (2015), reviewing the field, described a balance of costs (errors, decoupled perception) and possible benefits (planning, some forms of creativity). Deliberate, bounded wandering is therefore **plausible** as a useful state. Unintended wandering that the person does not notice is the costlier one.

The skill that makes a budget possible is **meta-awareness**: noticing that the mind has left. Schooler (2002) distinguished experience from the explicit awareness of that experience. People often fail to notice that they have drifted; unaware episodes tend to hurt performance more than ones the person has already caught (Smallwood and Schooler 2015). Catching the drift — “I am not in this conversation” — is **supported** as a real, trainable distinction, and it is the first move in the protocol below.

Two large-scale brain networks are often mentioned in this neighborhood. A default-mode network tends to be more active in undirected, inward, or stimulus-independent thought (Raichle et al. 2001). A more task-positive, attention-oriented network tends to trade off with it; the two can be anticorrelated even at rest (Fox, Snyder, Vincent, Corbetta, Van Essen, and Raichle 2005). That physiology is **supported**. Using it as a complete map of “Orun versus the kitchen” is **speculative**. The practical lesson does not need a scanner: inward and outward stances compete, and a cue can help you change stance.

Planned daydreaming, or scheduled absorption with an exit cue, is the design this evidence points toward. Set a time and a place to enter the inner world on purpose. Decide, in advance, what will end it — a timer, a bell, a doorway, a phrase, a living voice. That package is **plausible**. It borrows intentional mind-wandering, the value of a task cue (Rubinstein et al. 2001), implementation intentions (Gollwitzer 1999, already cited), and the idea that an event boundary can close one episode and open another (Section 5.4). It has not been tested as a named C-R-Z or Orun protocol.

Research on presence and absorption, including in virtual environments, shows that a well-built world can feel "here" (for a classic questionnaire approach, Witmer and Singer 1998). That is **supported** as a measurement tradition, and **plausible** as a description of why fiction is powerful. It does not, by itself, license any particular exit method, and it should not be over-read as proof that a person can inhabit two worlds at full strength at once.

5.2 The Drop: letting go of a complex or tempting thought

The author's Drop is already in C-R-Z as the first beat of Drop-Press-Snap, and in the Orun story as putting down the purse and the maps. This section is about using that same move on a thought that is complex, glittering, or hard to leave — and doing it as **letting go**, not as suppression.

Classic thought-stopping — a sudden "Stop!" meant to erase the thought — is a weak foundation. Wegner (1994) described ironic processes of mental control: an effortful attempt to push a thought away can be yoked to a monitor that keeps looking for that thought, and under load the unwanted thought becomes more available. That rebound risk is **supported**. It is one reason C-R-Z should not be taught as "crush the thought until it is gone."

What has a better neighbor in the clinic is not a fight. In Acceptance and Commitment Therapy, a person **defuses** from a thought by naming it as a thought — "I am having the thought that…" — rather than treating it as a command (Hayes, Strosahl, and Wilson 1999). The tug-of-war metaphor, often taught as **drop the rope**, makes the same point: you need not win against the thought; you can stop spending your strength on the struggle and step toward what matters. **Urge surfing** asks a person to feel a craving or a pull rise and fall, like a wave, without immediately acting on it (Bowen and Marlatt 2009, in a brief mindfulness intervention with smokers). These are **plausible** supports for a Drop that notices the thought, declines to wrestle it, and turns to a present cue. They are not a trial of C-R-Z, and defusion is a clinical method, not a parlor trick.

The form that ties this to the rest of the framework is an **implementation intention** plus a body drop. Gollwitzer (1999) showed that pre-decided if-then plans make a cue more likely to trigger a chosen act. The C-R-Z Drop, written that way, is:

> If I notice a thought that is looping, tempting, or pulling me out of this room, then I drop my shoulders, put my weight into my feet, let the thought be a thought, and look at one real thing (or one living face) here.

That is **plausible** as a package: meta-awareness supplies the "if," the body supplies a fast somatic interrupt, defusion supplies the stance (let go, do not suppress), and Reality-Return supplies the "then." It should be taught in those words, not as a guarantee that the thought will vanish.

5.3 Syncing back into a real conversation

Drifting in a conversation is ordinary. The repair is a skill, not a confession of failure.

Ordinary talk already has a system for fixing trouble. Schegloff, Jefferson, and Sacks (1977) described conversational repair, including a preference for people to correct themselves, and for others to prompt rather than overwrite. An honest sentence such as “Sorry, I drifted — can you say that last part again?” is **plausible** as good repair, and it is closer to that literature than bluffing or pretending you heard. There is no need to invent a new social science for the sentence. There is a need to give yourself permission to say it.

Once you are back, small **backchannel** cues (a nod, “mm,” “I see”) and a short paraphrase of what you just heard — reflective listening, in the tradition of Rogers and of later motivational interviewing — help the other person know you have landed, and help you check that you have. Those practices are **supported** as widely taught communication methods. As a snap-back kit they are **plausible**.

Re-anchor on what is actually in the conversation: the speaker’s face, the sound of their voice, and their last words. A practical catch-up some listeners use is to replay the **last three words** they are sure they heard, and to ask from there. As a named method, that trick is **speculative**. As a use of the most recent speech still in ear and memory, it is **plausible**, and it is kinder than inventing the missing middle.

This is the story’s own teaching in civic form. Relationships snap you back in reality. The living sentence, not the empty door, gets the reply.

5.4 Mental anchors for switching

Anchors are cues that help the mind change worlds on purpose, and find the way back.

Singing or humming the thought. Melody can make words more memorable. Wallace (1994) found that a melody could aid recall of text, under conditions that should not be over-generalized. Melodic intonation therapy has a clinical life in some aphasia work (Albert, Sparks, and Helm 1973), which is a different problem than everyday attention. Humming, because it lengthens the exhale, sits near the slow-breathing literature already graded in Section 3.6. Using a quiet hummed line, or singing a thought once in order to set it down and leave it, is **plausible** as a personal anchor. It is **speculative** as a special neural key, and it should be silent or nearly silent if a living conversation is in the room.

The environment. Outward naming (the 5-4-3-2-1 family, already discussed), a familiar object in the hand, a window, or the feel of a chair are present-tense cues. Context also colors memory: Godden and Baddeley (1975) found that divers recalled word lists better in the environment where they had learned them, land or water.

That is **supported** for memory, and **plausible** as a reason to give the inner world and the real world slightly different physical cues — a chair for writing Orun, the kitchen table for the living meal — so that each place helps you return to its task.

A short ritual to enter and leave the gate. Walking through a doorway can make information from the previous room less available; Radvansky, Krawietz, and Tamplin (2011) treated doorways as event boundaries that update the current event model. That effect is **supported**. Using a small phrase, a gesture, or an actual threshold as a "gate" into and out of the fictional world is **plausible**. It is the same shape as the Orun tali: a gate that opens slowly, and that you can also close. The words can be ordinary ("I am going in"; "I am coming back"). They do not need to be a spell.

Nature, bells, and a personal line. Kaplan's attention restoration theory (1995) proposes that some natural settings can rest directed attention through "soft fascination." The theory is influential; the evidence is mixed in size and design, so the honest grade is **plausible** as a reason to step outside, not **supported** as a proven dose. A timer or a bell is a simple external cue, in the same family as mindfulness of the bell in contemplative practice. A verse or a short prayer can be a personal cue of the same kind. Those are **plausible** as signals, and **[Values]** as content.

5.5 A selu attention-budget model

Treat attention as a limited coin, like selu.

- There is only so much to spend in an hour. You cannot pay full price to Orun and full price to the person in the chair.
- **Real people have priority.** If a living voice, a child, a colleague, or a need in the room arises, the inner world yields. That is the commons rule, not a punishment of imagination.
- **Absorption is allowed**, on purpose, with a budget and an exit cue: a start, an intended span, and a way back (timer, doorway, phrase, body Drop, a name said in this hour).
- **Spending on reality restores** the account in the only sense that matters here: you return, you repair if you drifted, and the next visit to the inner world is leaveable again. This is akin to Coherence Under Decay's rest that is not empty, and to residual decay that prevents a perfect hoarding shelter. An inner world with no nurev, no fade, and no exit becomes a vault.
- The sentence at the center is the author's: **Attention is life.** It is a values claim and a design rule. It is not a measured quantity, a currency, or a diagnosis.

The model is **speculative** as economics or neuroscience, and **plausible** as a compact way to remember the findings in Sections 5.1–5.4: switching has a cost, unnoticed drift has a cost, deliberate visits with a cue are safer than being quietly overwritten, and the living world gets first claim.

5.6 Take heart: the author’s closing anchor

The author adds a conviction from his faith. In the Gospel of John, Jesus says, “In the world ye shall have tribulation: but be of good cheer; I have overcome the world” (John 16:33, King James Version). A common modern rendering is “Take heart; I have overcome the world.”

This is presented as **the author’s belief**, respectfully, and as a personal closing anchor: a higher power has already overcome this world, so a person may put a thought, a fear, or even a beloved inner world down, and come back. It is **[Values]**. It is not a clinical result, not a substitute for 988 or for care, and not evidence that C-R-Z works. A reader who does not share the faith can use the rest of the protocol without it. A reader who does may keep the verse as the last gate-phrase, the way other people might keep a breath, a name, or a bell.

5.7 A practical protocol card

Protocol card: Attention as selu

One short sequence, to be used as a card, not as a treatment.

1. **Enter the gate.** If you are visiting the inner or fictional world on purpose, mark the start with a small phrase, a gesture, or a threshold. This is planned absorption, not a sneak departure from life.
2. **Set the budget.** Choose a span and an exit cue (a timer, a bell, a doorway, a verse, a body cue). Remember the priority rule: a living person, a real need, or a conversation already underway can close the gate early. Attention is life.
3. **Catch the drift.** When you are supposed to be in the real world and you notice you are not — "I am not in this conversation" — that noticing is the skill. You do not have to have been gone long for the noticing to count.
4. **Drop.** Do not wrestle the tempting or complex thought. Name it as a thought if that helps. Drop the shoulders, put weight into the feet, and look at one real thing. Let go; do not suppress.
5. **Sync back.** If a conversation is in progress, repair honestly: "Sorry, I drifted. Can you say that last part again?" Re-anchor on the speaker's face, voice, and last words. Paraphrase what you just heard. Answer the living sentence.
6. **Close the gate.** When the visit or the repair is done, mark the end the same way you marked the start. Come back all the way. If you use the author's faith-anchor, this is a place for "Take heart." Then give the room, not the leftover story, the next unit of attention.

If immersive daydreaming is crowding out work, relationships, sleep, or care, this card is not enough. See Section 7.

6. A simple, testable pilot

C-R-Z has not been tested as a package. A first study should be small, pre-registered, and willing to fail.

Design. A within-subject laboratory or quiet-room comparison, in randomized order, of Drop-Press-Snap versus a control after a mild, ethically acceptable stress or worry induction (for example, a brief worry period or a standard mild cognitive stressor). This first pilot should not use trauma-script exposure. A third arm, if the sample allows, could be an established brief comparison such as a minute of 5-4-3-2-1 or of exhale-emphasized breathing, so that the question is not only "better than sitting still?" but "different from its nearest neighbor?"

The C-R-Z arm, for the pilot, should use the reframed protocol: drop the shoulders and put weight into the heels and soles (or into the feet if seated); press the big toe and the ground, described only as a tactile anchor, with no reflexology map; make the agreed motor cue (ASL "C" against the leg, or a simple agreed alternative) and name, quietly, two or three things in the room. The author's original wording can be taught as the personal form of the practice, but the tested instructions should not include unsupported organ claims.

Control. Sit or stand still for the same number of seconds, with no special cue, or count backward as a nonspecific cognitive control. The protocol's duration should be fixed in advance (for example, 30–60 seconds).

Primary outcomes. (1) Change in subjective distress, on a 0–100 visual analogue scale or a Subjective Units of Distress rating, from post-induction to post-technique. (2) Change in heart rate over the same window.

Secondary outcomes. Respiratory rate; if a device is already in place, heart-rate variability, clearly labelled secondary in light of Balban et al. (2023); a short state-anxiety scale; a one-item "how present do you feel?" rating; and, if Calibration is a target, a one-item rumination rating. Qualitative comments on whether the cue felt usable in the moment.

Sample and ethics. A feasibility sample (for example, a few dozen adults). Informed consent. Ethics or IRB review if the results will be published or if a clinical population is recruited. Exclude people in acute crisis, uncontrolled psychosis, or current manic or mixed episodes. People with bipolar disorder who are stable may take part only with a pre-specified plan and, where appropriate, clinician awareness; mania warning signs during the study are a stop rule, not more protocol. Offer a seated version for anyone with balance risk. Data private by default.

What would support the design, as feasibility evidence only. A pre-specified, modest reduction in distress after Drop-Press-Snap relative to control, with or without a short-lived heart-rate change, without serious adverse events, and with most participants able to complete the sequence. Effects should be reported with uncertainty, not as proof that C-R-Z "works."

What would count against it. No difference from control on distress; distress that worsens for more than a rare, transient case; heart-rate claims that were promised in advance and do not appear (in which case drop or demote the physiological story); participants finding the reflexology language confusing or untrustworthy; or any signal that people with rising manic signs used the protocol instead of seeking care.

This is a first measurement, in the same spirit as the small app pilot in Coherence Under Decay, Section 9. It is not a registration of a treatment.

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7. Safety

C-R-Z is a personal practice framework. **It is not medical treatment, not a substitute for psychotherapy or medication, and not a crisis service.**

- In the United States, if you are in emotional crisis or thinking about suicide, call or text **988**. If you are in immediate danger, call **911**.
- If distress, panic, dissociation, or despair is severe, persistent, or worsening, contact a clinician or a local emergency service.
- **Mania or hypomania warning signs** — including markedly less need for sleep, a sustained burst of energy or confidence that others find unlike you, racing speech or spending, or a rising sense that ordinary limits no longer apply — warrant clinical follow-up. They are not "glimmers" to be ridden, and they are not a reason to intensify Drop-Press-Snap in place of care.
- People with trauma histories should keep the outward emphasis of Reality-Return. If a turn toward the body increases alarm or detachment, stop.
- The weight-shift in the Drop should not be done in a way that risks a fall. A seated version, with both feet on the floor, is a full version, not a lesser one.
- If immersive daydreaming, looping stories, or a fictional world begins to crowd out work, relationships, sleep, or ordinary care, that is a reason to seek professional help. Somer (2002) described **maladaptive daydreaming** as a pattern in which extensive, vivid fantasy becomes difficult to control and interferes with life. This protocol is not a treatment for that pattern.
- Nothing in this note is an instruction to leave prescribed medication or to delay emergency care.

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8. What this is not

- Not a validated treatment, diagnosis, or medical device.
- Not evidence that an ASL “C,” a foot reflex point, or a triangle gaze has a unique neural pathway.
- Not a confirmation of polyvagal theory, of reflexology, or of power-posing physiology.
- Not a claim that economics, quantum mechanics, or fiction prove a somatic protocol. Cross-references in Section 4 are structural and narrative, not empirical transfer.
- Not a promise that threat can be neutralized on demand, or that sovereignty can be made absolute.
- Not a reason to ignore other people when a living voice is the key that works.
- Not a claim that true, cost-free multitasking is possible, or that a fictional world can be inhabited at full strength at the same time as a living conversation.
- Not a treatment for maladaptive daydreaming, and not a license to disappear into an inner world when life is asking for attention.
- Not clinical evidence for a verse of Scripture. John 16:33 is offered as the author’s faith-anchor, not as a finding.

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9. Limitations

This audit is only as strong as the records checked on 13 November 2026, including the Attention as Selu sources added the same day. Some nearby literatures (for example, sensorimotor psychotherapy and somatic experiencing) were not reviewed in depth and should not be treated as silently endorsed or silently dismissed. The three source papers were not available to this draft as public, dated, paginated documents; the framework is taken from the author’s own synopsis, which he offered as the authoritative short form. If a later comparison with the full source papers shows a missed nuance, the source papers govern the description, and this audit should be revised.

The evidence tiers grade component claims, not the character of the author or the worth of the values layer. A speculative mechanism can sit next to a sound aim. The aim is not thereby proved, and the person is not thereby discredited.

A within-subject pilot will not settle long-term use, clinical populations, or the daily V2 adaptations. Demand characteristics are likely: people who believe in a sequence will often report that it helped. Pre-registration, a credible control, and at least one physiological measure that can fail are partial guards, not complete ones.

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10. Recommendations

1. Keep the three-part shape: interrupt, look outward, come to rest on the ground.
2. Keep Drop-Press-Snap as a brief sequence, with the Press reframed as a toe-and-sole attention anchor, and with a documented alternative to the ASL “C.”
3. Keep the breath, the open hands, and a soft outward gaze, described in ordinary language, without special-mechanism claims.
4. Replace “mania glimmers” with “mania early-warning signs” or “prodromes,” and keep “glimmers,” if at all, for small cues of present safety.
5. Write Zero-Velocity as an approach to rest (v approaching a floor, not v = 0), in line with Coherence Under Decay.
6. Let relationship stay inside Reality-Return: a living voice is a valid key.
7. Run the pilot in Section 6 before any public claim that the package regulates the vagus, hormones, or threat “at the hardware level.”
8. Leave the values — sovereignty, grace, the right to leave, collective peace as an exhaled hope, and “Attention is life” — labelled as values.
9. Treat attention as a limited selu budget, with living people first, and allow inner-world absorption only with a span and an exit cue.
10. Teach the Drop as an if-then plus a body drop, and as letting go, not as thought-stopping.
11. Keep “Take heart; I have overcome the world” (John 16:33) in the values layer, as the author’s closing anchor, not as a clinical claim.

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11. References

11.1 Source papers for the framework

1. Ryan Espinosa, The Unified C-R-Z Somatic-Kinetic Framework, working paper.
2. Ryan Espinosa, Returning to Reality and Neutralizing Threat Responses, V1 and V2, working papers.
3. Ryan Espinosa, Everyday C-R-Z: The Low-Friction Architecture, working paper.

The synopsis of pillars, Drop-Press-Snap, and V2 adaptations used in this note was provided by the author on 13 November 2026.

11.2 Related notes in this collection

1. Ryan Espinosa, with Grok Bot, Coherence Under Decay: A Shared Control Template for Qubits and a Zero-Debt Commons, 12 November 2026, MindFrame research notes, Coherence-Under-Decay.
2. Ryan Espinosa, with Grok Bot, Dynamic Boundary Control and Vacuum-Referenced Stabilization of Qubits: A conceptual research proposal for Project Ariel (revised), 12 November 2026, Quantum-Boundary-Proposal.

3. Ryan Espinosa, Selu Cannot Buy the Morning Back and The Path of Rivel (Orun narrative and game, 2026), including the skill of dropping everything, listening for a key to reality, and exiting the gate.

11.3 Literature checked for this draft

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11.4 AI assistant

1. Grok Bot (2026). AI assistant used, under the author’s direction, to help draft this note, look up and format literature, cross-reference the author’s related papers, and prepare the PDF. Grok Bot is an AI assistant. It is not a co-investigator, not a clinician, and not a source of primary evidence. Every empirical claim in this note is only as strong as the published record it cites.

All credit and glory to God.